

LangChain Document Structure

Understanding the core components of LangChain Documents



LangChain Document

```
from langchain.schema import Document
```

Core Components:

- **page_content (str)**
- **metadata (dict)**

```
# Creating a Document
doc = Document(
    page_content= "RAG is a technique...",
    metadata={
        "source": "chapter1.pdf",
        "page" : 5,
        "timestamp" : "2024-01-15"
    }
)
```

page_content (String)

The actual text content of the document

- Contains the main information to be embedded and searched
- Must be a string (can be any length)

Examples:

Research Paper:

"Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) combines the benefits of pre-trained language models with information retrieval systems to generate more accurate and contextual responses..."

Product Manual:

"To install the software, first ensure your system meets the minimum requirements: Windows 10 or later, 8GB RAM, and at least 20GB of free disk space..."

Best Practices:

- Keep content focused and coherent
- Remove unnecessary formatting before storage
- Consider chunk size limits (typically 500-2000 tokens)

metadata (Dictionary)

Additional information about the document

- Used for filtering, tracking, and context
- Can contain any JSON-serializable data

Common Metadata Fields:

source

File path or URL
"docs/manual.pdf"

page / chunk_id

Location in document
page: 42, chunk: 7

timestamp

Creation/modification date
"2024-01-15T10:30:00Z"

author

Document creator
"John Doe"

category / type

Document classification
"technical", "legal"

language

Content language
"en", "es", "fr"

Tip: Add custom fields for your use case

Examples: department, security_level, version, keywords, embeddings_model

LangChain Document Loaders

PDFLoader

```
from langchain.document_loaders import PyPDFLoader
loader = PyPDFLoader("file.pdf")
documents = loader.load()
```

CSVLoader

```
from langchain.document_loaders import CSVLoader
loader = CSVLoader("data.csv")
documents = loader.load()
```

WebBaseLoader

```
from langchain.document_loaders import WebBaseLoader
loader = WebBaseLoader("https://...")
documents = loader.load()
```

DirectoryLoader

```
from langchain.document_loaders import DirectoryLoader
loader = DirectoryLoader("./docs")
documents = loader.load()
```

Additional Loaders:

- | | | | |
|---|-------------------------|-------------------|----------------------------|
| • UnstructuredLoader (multiple formats) | • NotionDirectoryLoader | • S3FileLoader | • ConfluenceLoader |
| • JSONLoader | • GoogleDriveLoader | • YouTubeLoader | • DocugamiLoader |
| • TextLoader | • AirtableLoader | • WikipediaLoader | • EverNoteLoader |
| • GitbookLoader | • SlackDirectoryLoader | • ArxivLoader | • HuggingFaceDatasetLoader |

Document Transformers (Text Splitters)

CharacterTextSplitter

```
splitter = CharacterTextSplitter(
    chunk_size=1000,
    chunk_overlap=200
)
```

RecursiveCharacterTextSplitter

```
splitter = RecursiveCharacterTextSplitter(
    chunk_size=1000,
    separators=["\n\n", "\n", " "]
)
```

TokenTextSplitter

```
splitter = TokenTextSplitter(
    chunk_size=500,
    model_name="gpt-3.5-turbo"
)
```

SemanticChunker

```
splitter = SemanticChunker(
    embeddings,
    breakpoint_threshold_type="percentile"
)
```

```
# Split documents into chunks
chunks = splitter.split_documents(documents)

# Each chunk is a new Document with preserved metadata
```